Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers

Take away each place. Not enough? Break a ten or a hundred.

468 – 135: take away each place



hundreds	400 – 100 = 300
tens	60 – 30 = 30
ones	8 – 5 = 3
total	300 + 30 + 3 = 333

452 – 127: 2 – 7? Break a ten

break	452 = 400 + 40 + 12
hundreds	400 – 100 = 300
tens	40 – 20 = 20
ones	12 – 7 = 5
total	300 + 20 + 5 = 325

528 – 263: 2 tens – 6 tens? Break a hundred

break	528 = 400 + 120 + 8
hundreds	400 – 200 = 200
tens	120 – 60 = 60
ones	8 – 3 = 5
total	200 + 60 + 5 = 265

Your turn!

643 – 281 = ☐

break	643 = ☐ + ☐ + ☐
hundreds	☐ – 200 = ☐
tens	☐ – 80 = ☐
ones	☐ – 1 = ☐
total	☐ + ☐ + ☐ = ☐

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice

Take away each place. Break a ten or a hundred when you need to.

Part 1 Take away hundreds Only the hundreds change.

1) 700 − 300 = ☐

2) 650 − 200 = ☐

3) 900 − 600 = ☐

4) 840 − 500 = ☐

5) 500 − 100 = ☐

6) 975 − 300 = ☐

7) 380 − 200 = ☐

8) 760 − 400 = ☐

9) 430 − 100 = ☐

Part 2 What is left? The crossed-out parts are taken away. Count what is left.

10) 

357 − 124 = ☐

11) 

486 − 152 = ☐

12) 

279 − 135 = ☐

13) 

395 − 271 = ☐

14) 

148 − 36 = ☐

15) 

264 − 142 = ☐

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 3 Break a ten Not enough ones. The break row is done for you.

16) **362 − 128 = ☐**

break 362 = 300 + 50 + 12

hundreds ☐ − 100 = ☐

tens ☐ − 20 = ☐

ones ☐ − 8 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ + ☐ = ☐

17) **571 − 245 = ☐**

break 571 = 500 + 60 + 11

hundreds ☐ − 200 = ☐

tens ☐ − 40 = ☐

ones ☐ − 5 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ + ☐ = ☐

18) **483 − 159 = ☐**

break 483 = 400 + 70 + 13

hundreds ☐ − 100 = ☐

tens ☐ − 50 = ☐

ones ☐ − 9 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ + ☐ = ☐

19) **640 − 215 = ☐**

break 640 = 600 + 30 + 10

hundreds ☐ − 200 = ☐

tens ☐ − 10 = ☐

ones ☐ − 5 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ + ☐ = ☐

Part 4 Break a hundred Not enough tens. The break row is done for you.

20) **418 − 154 = ☐**

break 418 = 300 + 110 + 8

hundreds ☐ − 100 = ☐

tens ☐ − 50 = ☐

ones ☐ − 4 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ + ☐ = ☐

21) **625 − 371 = ☐**

break 625 = 500 + 120 + 5

hundreds ☐ − 300 = ☐

tens ☐ − 70 = ☐

ones ☐ − 1 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ + ☐ = ☐

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 4 Break a hundred (continued)

22) **537 − 281 = ☐**

break 537 = 400 + 130 + 7

hundreds ☐ − 200 = ☐

tens ☐ − 80 = ☐

ones ☐ − 1 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ + ☐ = ☐

23) **806 − 452 = ☐**

break 806 = 700 + 100 + 6

hundreds ☐ − 400 = ☐

tens ☐ − 50 = ☐

ones ☐ − 2 = ☐

total ☐ + ☐ + ☐ = ☐

Part 5 Stack it Cross out and write the new digits on top, then subtract.

24)

hundreds	tens	ones
☐	☐	☐
4	5	3
− 1	2	8
☐	☐	☐

25)

hundreds	tens	ones
☐	☐	☐
7	2	4
− 3	6	1
☐	☐	☐

26)

hundreds	tens	ones
☐	☐	☐
3	8	5
− 1	4	2
☐	☐	☐

27)

hundreds	tens	ones
☐	☐	☐
9	1	6
− 5	7	3
☐	☐	☐

Part 6 Nothing to break No help this time.

28)

5	8	7
− 2	4	3
☐	☐	☐

29)

8	9	6
− 1	5	4
☐	☐	☐

30)

4	7	9
− 3	2	6
☐	☐	☐

31)

6	5	8
− 4	0	5
☐	☐	☐

32)

9	3	7
− 6	1	2
☐	☐	☐

33)

7	6	4
− 5	3	1
☐	☐	☐

34)

3	4	9
− 1	2	7
☐	☐	☐

35)

8	7	5
− 2	3	4
☐	☐	☐

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 7 Break a ten No help this time.

36) $\begin{array}{r} 473 \\ -\ 138 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

37) $\begin{array}{r} 652 \\ -\ 319 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

38) $\begin{array}{r} 381 \\ -\ 156 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

39) $\begin{array}{r} 794 \\ -\ 368 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

40) $\begin{array}{r} 560 \\ -\ 234 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

41) $\begin{array}{r} 842 \\ -\ 517 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

42) $\begin{array}{r} 931 \\ -\ 405 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

43) $\begin{array}{r} 275 \\ -\ 149 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

Part 8 Break a hundred No help this time.

44) $\begin{array}{r} 527 \\ -\ 184 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

45) $\begin{array}{r} 648 \\ -\ 273 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

46) $\begin{array}{r} 915 \\ -\ 341 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

47) $\begin{array}{r} 436 \\ -\ 192 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

48) $\begin{array}{r} 708 \\ -\ 354 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

49) $\begin{array}{r} 352 \\ -\ 171 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

50) $\begin{array}{r} 823 \\ -\ 492 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

51) $\begin{array}{r} 619 \\ -\ 287 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 9 Mixed Break only when you need to.

52)

$$\begin{array}{r} 586 \\ -\ 231 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

53)

$$\begin{array}{r} 743 \\ -\ 528 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

54)

$$\begin{array}{r} 467 \\ -\ 293 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

55)

$$\begin{array}{r} 895 \\ -\ 462 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

56)

$$\begin{array}{r} 634 \\ -\ 219 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

57)

$$\begin{array}{r} 521 \\ -\ 180 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

58)

$$\begin{array}{r} 978 \\ -\ 345 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

59)

$$\begin{array}{r} 362 \\ -\ 137 \\ \hline \square\square\square \end{array}$$

Subtracting Three-Digit Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 10 Word problems Take away each place.

60) A library has 485 books. Kids borrow 132 of them. How many books are left?

Number sentence _____

Answer ☐ books

Draw or show your work

61) A farm had 352 eggs. It sold 127 eggs. How many eggs are left?

Number sentence _____

Answer ☐ eggs

Draw or show your work

62) There are 628 seats in a hall, and 274 seats are full. How many seats are empty?

Number sentence _____

Answer ☐ seats

Draw or show your work

63) Ben had 540 stickers. He gave away 215 stickers. How many stickers does he have now?

Number sentence _____

Answer ☐ stickers

Draw or show your work

64) Challenge: A store had 900 pencils. It sold 350, then 120 more. How many pencils are left?

Number sentence _____

Answer ☐ pencils

Draw or show your work